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Wellington & District
LEADER

Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Eucharéena, Geurie, Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbone and Yeoval districts.

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WELLINGTON RACE CLUB

BOXING DAY RACES
Friday, 26 December
Let the whole family relax after a hectic Christmas Day
It's a family fun day

Craft Co-operative donations - P3

Vivienne Putland farewell - P4

Swim Pointscore P23

Guys and Dolls to feature at 2026 Wellington Boot

MS WELLINGTON Boot is making a comeback with a twist!

It's been more than a decade since the last Ms Wellington Boot contest, so by popular demand the Boot Racing Carnival next year will feature the 2026 Tooheys Wellington Boot Guys and Dolls Quest, sponsored by Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club with the *Wellington & District Leader* and Wellington Race Club will be open to males and females aged 18 to 30 years.

Nominations will open early next year.

It's been a long time since the last fun-filled contest, so according to race club president, Peter Barton, a comeback is long overdue. "Thanks to our three sponsors this contest will enhance the Central West's most popular and richest race meeting," Mr Barton said.

The Guys and Dolls Quest has been planned by two keen Wellington Boot promoters, Sharon Wilson of the *Leader* and Jane Angelini of the Soldiers Club who saw a need to reintroduce a human side to the fun-filled race of the west.

In the race's early years, girls were nominated by businesses and others interested in racing and promotion of the Boot carnival.

However, times have changed and both Sharon and Jane believe the boys also need to be let into the fun – hence Guys and Dolls.

How the Quest works is very simple. People are nominated and those nominees get the chance to pick a horse running in the Wellington Boot.

All nominees need to attend the 2026 Boot Calcutta on Saturday, April 11, draw a horse, then enjoy a day at the races with the complements of all four sponsors.

The guy or doll who selected the winning horse of the race is crowned the winner and second and third placings also gain prizes.

It's that simple, so start getting ready and nominate yourself or someone else when the competition begins in early 2026.



Week
4
Inside

2025 Magical Christmas Feature
Support Locals in Wellington & Geurie

- * Ben's Tyres
- * Caves Wood Gallery & Gifts
- * Cusack's Butchery
- * Four Cats Coffee
- * Jacinta Haycock Gallery
- * Jespresso Cafe
- * Mallee Hen's Nest & Cafe
- * N J Jewellers
- * Notts Rural and Domestic
- * One Stop Auto
- * Styled By Sim
- * T & N Auto and Ag Services
- * The Lemon Tree Cafe
- * Wellington Craft Co-op

Cattle sale breaks record again!

DUBBO SALEYARDS have recorded back-to-back weeks of record sales, with Thursday November 27 reaching the dizzying new heights of 11,010 head.

This eclipsed the previous record of 10,180 head from the week before.

Strong market conditions, seasonal change and consistent high prices have all contributed to the record yardings.

In the past 12 months Dubbo regularly delivers feeder steer prices above the national average, while other categories also maintain premium rates.

Congratulations to everyone who has contributed to the record numbers. From the vendors, agents, buyers, staff and carriers - you've all done an amazing job.

Seniors Christmas morning tea
The combined DRC Wellington and Dubbo Seniors Christmas Morning Tea was held this week at the Wellington Civic Centre.

It was a fantastic morning with performances from the children at Wellington Family Day Care, Wellington Christian School, Wellington Public School, the Macquarie Conservatorium Ladies Choir,

and young soloist Elora Wayman.

Food and drinks were served by the students from Wellington High School.

Heavy patching begins

Council advises that the 2025/2026 heavy patching program will start this month.

Works will be undertaken on a number of sections of road across the Local Government Area. These works are due to be completed by Friday, December 12, weather permitting.

Stop and slow traffic management will be in place during the daytime while works are being undertaken. The works will improve the quality of the road surface, ensuring a smoother and safer ride.

Nominate someone for an Australia Day Award!

Do you know someone who contributes to our community?

Nominations are being accepted until 5pm Wednesday, January 7, 2026 for the Dubbo and Wellington 2026 Australia Day Awards.

Categories for Wellington nominations:

Citizen of the Year; Senior Citizen of the Year; Young Citizen of the Year; Sportsperson of the Year; Young Sportsperson of the Year; Services to Sport Award; Community Event of the Year; Community Service/Achievement Award
Submit your nominations today.

Fresh Start - Apprentice heavy vehicle mechanic - Wellington

Join our team at Fleet and Depot Services based in Wellington to provide high-quality services, support and facilities to the growing communities of Wellington, Dubbo and surrounding areas.

Closing date: 9am on December 12, 2025.

Summer reading at the Library

The Big Summer Read is a reading incentive program for ages 5 to 16 years, running from Monday 1 December 2025 to Saturday 31 January 2026 through the Macquarie Regional Library.

The program aims to help maintain literacy levels over the summer school holiday period.

To join Big Summer Read, visit your local Macquarie Regional Library branch and pick up a log to track your reading.

Children mark off each day they read a book, magazine, graphic novel or listen to an audiobook. At the end of the program, children return their completed log to their local library to receive a prize and an entry into the major prize draw.

Not a member of the Macquarie Regional Library? You can join for free.

Building a better airport together

The Dubbo City Regional Airport is a vital link to Sydney and beyond for many in our region and also for western NSW, and we want to hear your feedback.

Council is running a community survey to seek insights into improving your airport experience.

The survey should take 3 to 4 minutes of your time, and you have a chance to win a \$500 flight voucher for completing it!

Survey closes 5pm on Friday 12

December. Take the survey at Council's YourSay page.

Josh Black

New resources to address abuse of older women and women with disability

DURING THIS year's 16 Days of Activism to End Gender-Based Violence, the State Government is shining a spotlight on the abuse of older women and women with disability.

To equip frontline workers to detect and respond to abuse, the government has launched a suite of training modules and resources to address domestic, family and sexual violence (DFSV).

Evidence from the Ageing and Disability Commission shows almost two-thirds of reports received relate to the abuse of women.

Women with disability are significantly more likely to experience violence.

Ageing and Disability Commission data shows a 109 per cent rise in reports of abuse against older people and people with disability, with nearly 19,000 reports received over a five-year period to June 2024.

This year the government invested an additional \$8 million in the Ageing and Disability Commis-

sion, lifting the baseline funding to support its vital work to \$7.2 million per year.

The new DFSV materials provide frontline workers with free training and resources tailored to older women and women with disability, covering a range of topics: identifying signs of abuse, harmful attitudes and behaviours; tips for documenting DFSV; safety planning; supporting victim-survivors to report; responding to disclosures of abuse and referral pathways.

In a first for NSW, the Ageing and Disability Commission partnered with the NSW Women's Safety Commissioner to develop the resources, consulting older women, women with disability and sector experts.

These are designed to be used by frontline workers, advocates and other support workers in the disability, ageing, and/or DFSV sectors.

Learn more about the DFSV resources on the Ageing and Disability Commission website.

Call for national monitor to prevent food freeze

FARM LEADERS have warned Australia's fuel insecurity could trigger a nationwide freeze in food deliveries to supermarkets and global consumers within days in the event of an international emergency.

The warning comes as the state's peak farm body launches a call for a new national program to monitor stocks of key agricultural inputs such as fuel to ensure food security amid continuing international trade turmoil.

With Australia carrying just 22 days of diesel reserves onshore, NSW Farmers Acting CEO Mike Guerin said a serious program to monitor fuel stocks was nothing short of critical.

"Our fuel insecurity is the leak in the tank that could drain our nation of vital food supplies and export markets in just days," he said.

"One iceberg sank the Titanic, but a thousand things could stop our oil tankers from reaching Australian shores.

"And no fuel means no farm machinery, no tractors, no trucks – and that means no food on shelves, no food in

shops, and no food leaving our shores."

Mapping of the supply chains that provide fuel and other inputs to the nation must be included within any new program to monitor stocks of these supplies, Mr Guerin said, alongside an early warning system to alert the nation to shortages before it was too late. "Farmers deserve to know when a shortage of fuel, fertiliser or another key input is imminent, so they can

prepare accordingly," he said. "The program should also be working actively to prevent shortages of these inputs, and have plans in place to relieve shortages when they occur.

"This isn't about triggering panic buying but about preventing a national standstill in food supplies – and with 27 million hungry mouths to feed just in Australia, we just can't keep risking it until the system fails."

New drive to reduce road toll

BETTER ROADS, not slower trucks, are what's needed to reduce the surging road toll in the regions, NSW Farmers has told a state inquiry.

Studies have shown farm workers are four-times more likely to die on the nation's roads than any other driver, with NSW's local roads facing a \$3.4 billion backlog in repairs.

Serious investment in local road funding was long overdue, NSW Farmers' Business Economics and Trade Committee Chair John Lowe said, with broader solutions to road repair still nowhere in sight.

"Drivers have been forced to navigate dangerous potholes, uneven surfaces and other serious hazards on our roads for far too long, and we simply can't continue with roads like this," Mr Lowe said.

"Serious and sustainable funding to fix our local roads, our truck rest stops, our overtaking lanes and our bridges is money well spent, because it could save lives."

Efficient and connected rail networks were also urgently needed to reduce the pressure trucks were placing on the state's roads with better driver education and expanded mobile

coverage also key to improve road safety.

"Trucks are only adding to the wear and tear on our roads, and rail lines, in the right place, in the right condition, will really take the heat off," Mr Lowe said.

"Drivers also need to have the skills to drive to the conditions, and the ability to call for help when they need to, no matter where they are in the state.

We've got a long road ahead to improve our road safety – but it's only by addressing the root causes of the problem, that we can keep our regional communities safe."

Obituaries of our loved ones are welcomed for publication in the 'Leader'.

Contact: mark@wdleader.news

Wellington & District
LEADER

In Memory of Beryl O'Brien
Covering news and views particularly from within the Wellington region, which now runs from Euchareena to Elong Elong within Dubbo Regional Council Local Government Area.

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Craft sales enable huge donation to feed and support local children

THE GENEROSITY of Wellington Craft Cooperative members is overwhelming.

This year some \$4000 in presents and gift cards have been donated to Wellington schools and Barnardos to share and provide for under privileged children from within this town and district.

Last week the Co-op presented donations from the organisation's annual profits.

Among these were supermarket gift cards totalling \$800 presented to St Mary's Catholic School for the school's Breakfast Club, where up to 22 students are prepared breakfast prior to the commencement of classes.

Wellington Public School gained \$1000 worth of gift cards for their Before and After School Care (BASC) program, while Barnardos received toys and gifts to the value of \$1300 to young people at Barnardo's as Christmas and birthday presents.

Upwards of 40 young people attend the Barnardos' after school activities each day at corner of Percy and Maxwell Streets.



ABOVE: Margaret Broome of Barnardos Wellington (centre) is presented dozens of Christmas gifts to be distributed among the organisation's local after school children.



LEFT: In another presentation Co-op members present gift cards to local school Breakfast club programs. From left are Co-op members Patricia Leclercq, Kerrie Sumner with St Mary's Danielle Sears Co-op's Penny Cook and Kay Triplett and Janelle Frappell from the Public school BASC program.

Hold the phone! Australians increasingly confident to use their mobiles while driving

AUSTRALIANS are becoming increasingly confident to drive while using their mobile phones.

The shock findings are contained in a survey of 1000 Australian drivers by car insurer Budget Direct. Exactly 22 per cent of drivers felt confident using their phone while driving.

The five-year trend paints a worrying picture for road safety authorities, with confidence growing at a steady rate.

In2020 – 12pc; 2023 – 19pc; 2025 – 22pc.

Almost half the survey respondents (45pc) admitted using their phone while driving in the past two weeks.

The main way they used their phone while driving was to use a navigation app (23pc), followed by checking the phone while stopped at traffic lights (8pc).

More than six per cent of people who answered the survey changed songs on a playlist and another 3pc read or replied to a text message.

Nearly 44pc of respondents said they used the phone because they felt safe and capable to do so.

Exactly 17pc admitted it was a habit, and 15pct claimed it was an emergency.

Victoria, New South Wales, Queensland and recently South Australia have changed the rules to enable tap and go payments in drive-throughs.

Elsewhere, drivers need to ensure they put their car in park before picking up their phone.

"Our survey revealed nearly 54 per cent of respondents felt it should be legal," Mr Kerr said.

"Twenty-nine per cent said only if the car was turned off; and 18pc said it was never okay to pay with your phone in the drive-through."

Despite the increasing confidence in using a phone while driving, 30pc of drivers surveyed felt texting while driving was most likely to result in a road fatality, putting it as more dangerous than speeding (18pc)

and not wearing a seatbelt (5pc).

Only drink driving (40pc) was considered more likely to result in fatality.

Those results were reversed in older demographics, with 58-67 year-olds (43pc) and 68-75 year-olds (39pc) believing texting was more dangerous than drink driving.

So, what would discourage drivers from using their phones while driving?

Tougher penalties, according to 35pc of respondents.

Mobile detection cameras came in second at 23pc, with 18pc preferring increased awareness of distracted driving.

More than12pc drivers asked said nothing would be effective. ***

Editor's note

This survey reveals the limitations authority have on mobile phone use while driving. It looks similar to drug use – how can it be eliminated, as both are increasing at an amazing pace.

Centre Open

Yoga with Catherine Thursdays 5:30pm

Seniors' Tai Chi Fridays 9:30am

Open Sundays 1pm to 4pm

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Geurie friends farewell Vivienne Putland

IT WAS a packed house at Geuire Bowling Club last Friday evening as dozens of local wellwishers gathered to surprise their friend and neighbour Vivienne Putland to say farewell. And a surprise it was, as Vivienne entered the club for what was supposed to be just a farewell drink with dinner.



ABOVE: Barbara Long with Vivienne.



The gathering of family and friends with Vivienne Putland at Geurie Bowling Club last Friday evening.



RIGHT: Harold and Noella Baker.



Best friends Noella Baker, Vivienne Putland, Karin Vrouggy and Barb Loughnan.



Vivienne with her family - son Mark with Emma and children, and daughter Bec with Heath and daughter.



Even familiar crossings can be fatal.



You know this road.

You've crossed it hundreds of times.
But when it comes to rail crossings, being
too familiar or complacent can be fatal.

No matter how well you know the way,
never assume the tracks are clear.
Because making sure, means making it home.

Slow down. Look. Listen for trains.



Simone McManus drew the winning ticket at her Styled by Sim hair-dressing salon in Swift Street last Friday. This was draw No: 3 of the Leader’s Magical Christmas local shopping promotion.

Two more draws to go

THREE LUCKY winners of \$100 are already enjoying the benefits from entering the *Wellington & District Leader* 2025 Magical Christmas promotion. And there’s two more \$100 prizes to be drawn, the next will be at N J Jewellers tomorrow (Friday afternoon). Each lucky winner can choose where to spend their \$100 bonus from one of the 15 participating businesses (see the feature on pages 11to 14). Our first winner was Michelle O’Brien, drawn by Sam Harries of

Jespresso Cafe in Lee Street. Michelle chose to spend her winnings at Cusack’s Butchery. Our second winner was Robyn Walker, drawn by Ben Blackhall at Ben’s Tyres. Robyn chose to spend her winning at Malley Hen’s Nest. Sim McManus at Styled by Sim drew our third winner, Caitlyn Kerin, who decided to spend her winnings at Jespresso Cafe. So will you be the lucky person tomorrow? Keep filling-in the coupons each time you purchase at any of our participating businesses.

“Every bite counts” – GLP-1 weight loss medicines and the future of food

THE SURGE in usage of ‘GLP-1’-style weight loss medications is seeing a “ripple effect” begin to unfold, impacting eating patterns in a number of countries around the world, Rabobank says in recently-released research. In the global report, Every bite counts: GLP-1s and the future of food, the agribusiness bank’s RaboResearch division says “weight loss medications mark a turning point for food consumption”. While it’s early days and “the scale of these shifts is still evolving”, the report says, “the direction is clear – eating patterns are changing and no (food) category is immune”, with users of these medicines eating both less and differently. “Not everyone will use GLP-1s, but the user base will grow large enough to shape mainstream (food) demand,” the report forecasts, “much like vegans, ‘flexitarians’ and well-ness-driven consumers already do.” Adoption of weight loss medications – such as glucagon-like peptide-1 receptor agonists (known as GLP-1s) – is surging in the United States, with Europe, and particularly the United Kingdom, following rapidly, RaboResearch

says. Australia is not far behind, says RaboResearch Australia general manager Stefan Vogel, with recent public health research* indicating total Australian GLP-1 sales increased almost 10-fold from May 2020 to reach 496,875 units in April 2025. And uptake globally will continue to accelerate, the report predicts, as costs of the medication fall, pill forms become available (providing greater appeal to more users than the current injections) and cover by health insurers expands in several countries. For the food sector, the implications of the growing global popularity of weight loss medication are “fundamental”, RaboResearch says, representing both disruption and opportunity for the industry. “People will eat less and growth will hinge on creating more value per bite,” the report says, with “less but better” becoming the norm. “Category impact will vary. Snacks and indulgent staples face sharper disruption, but also stand to gain if they evolve. “Dairy, fresh foods and functional beverages are better positioned to benefit.”

Donors come from near and far

WELLINGTON LIONS’ pre-loved book shop has become known throughout the state as people are coming from Sydney and the Blue Mountains to donate books and jigsaw puzzles. This means that the shop can change stock around and pass on books that have been in our shop for a while. A special thankyou goes to those donors, and to those people who have offered their time to get the boxes of books to towns further out bush, especially ‘Luke Books for the Bush’, who called in the other day and picked up 350 books which he will take as far away as Tibooburra and into south Queensland. The ultimate re-use / recycling! Lions are also busy selling Christmas cakes and puddings from their preloved book shop and a few other outlets in town, including Wellington Craft Co-op and Caves Wood Gallery, while Central Butchery and Cusack’s Butchers have only cakes for sale.

The new Gluten Free varieties are proving to be popular. Don’t miss out! Sales of the cakes and puddings will continue while stock is available but the last date of trading this year for the book shop will be Saturday, December 20. Re-opening Saturday, January 10. Lions were pleased to be able to donate a box of Mini Christmas Cakes to the Wellington Seniors Centre for their Christmas Lunch recently. Don’t forget all money raised comes back to the town or to charities and foundations that Lion members choose. There is a full list of the last financial year donations in our preloved book shop so come and have a look! Lions are looking forward to the Christmas Carols in Cameron Park where we will be barbe-cuing and will have Lions Christmas Cakes and Puddings to sell - if they have any left!

Art mural class in town

THIS FRIDAY and Saturday, December 5 and 6, artist Jack Randell is conducting a mural painting workshop on the wall of Kitch & Son corner shop on Maughan and Percy Streets. Jack Randell these workshops will include painting activities, but no previous experience is necessary. “Just bring your enthusiasm and a willingness to get creative,” he said. “All materials will be provided, so simply come along in clothes you don’t mind getting a little paint on”. Participants will be guided through set-by-step creative activities and fun demonstrations to realise a brand-new community mural. Registration is required: <https://www.artclub-dub.com/art-classes>

Letters to the editor

Thanks for the paper, Mark. I always find something of interest and certainly people I know. A little heads up - my son lives at Geurie and is involved in the Rugby Club. My brother, Jack Randell, is organising a mural painting in town and my younger brother is moving back to Wellington in the next week or so. Wellington Lions Club generously donated \$2000 to Harrington Lions Club after the floods we had in the area. It was a lovely gesture and the funds were used to support families in our area. There are still families affected by the damaged caused - as an example I have a friend whose home is still waiting on repairs after nearly six months. I like your promotion for people to shop locally - it’s very important in a smaller town. I hope you didn’t get any damage from the storms today. I am amazed at some of the pictures I have seen. Take care, **Lynne Randell Smith**



Chrissie Wilkins received a box of mini-Christmas cakes from Lions’ Chris Hardy for Senior Citizens’ Christmas lunch.



Lion Ann helps pass on 350 books to Lukes Books for the Bush.

Incentive, not a fine

AAP report THE FEDERAL government has unveiled a proposal that would charge social media platforms and search engines that refuse to strike commercial deals with local news publishers. Assistant Treasurer Daniel Mulino refused to label the measure as a fine, stressing the "incentive" would ensure sustainable journalism in Australia. The proposal builds on the existing News Media Bargaining Code, which has delivered hundreds of millions of dollars to the news sector since 2021. Unlike the earlier framework, the new plan can’t be avoided by simply removing news from platforms, ensuring tech companies contribute to public interest journalism in some capacity. The consultation period is open until December 19.

Roger Everett ponders on ‘progress’ Would those who remember wonder how a number of Doctors, Nelson’s Hardware, Kimbell’s Bakery, MM Company, Kitches, Brudellins Jewellery, Preston’s Clothing, Bills Cafe, Munns Babyware, Larrums, Blowes Mensware, several butchers, a number of Milk Bar cafes, several Hotels, numerous Corner Stores etc etc all survived and once prospered at the same time in wonderful Wello. What has changed and how should we measure progress? Has the invitation to all levels of Government in our lives for more regulation, wage and employee requirements, and restrictions been progressive for us? Has the change in structure and purpose of Local Councils been progressive for us? Has the emergence and proliferation of Compensation Lawyers and resultant litigation and Insurance been progressive for us? Has the empowerment of minorities and resultant activism been progressive for anyone? Has the lack of face-to-face communication been progressive for anyone?

Andrew GEE MP

INDEPENDENT FEDERAL MEMBER FOR CALARE

Your True Country
Independent



RUNS ON THE BOARD FOR WELLINGTON

- ✓ \$9.5 million for Maranatha House Aged Care
- ✓ Introduced Bill into Parliament to ban foreign buying of residential property for two years. The Coalition and the Labor Party voted against it and then they both announced it as their policy!
- ✓ Backed Independents' Bill to reduce dominance of big supermarkets. All major parties voted against it and then Coalition announced it as their policy!
- ✓ \$50 million for storm and flood recovery in the Central West
- ✓ Secured the Parliamentary Inquiry into the Disaster
- ✓ Response of Insurers \$2 billion for Great Western Highway upgrade
- ✓ \$2.02 million for replacing the Terrabella, Burrendong and Gundy Creek Bridges
- ✓ \$738,000 for the Cameron Park footbridge
- ✓ 60 mobile phone towers and base stations for Calare
- ✓ \$560,000 for Stuart Town water security project
- ✓ Secured upgrade of Wellington Hospital Emergency Department
- ✓ \$1.5 million for the intergenerational childcare facility at
- ✓ Wellington's Maranatha House
- \$1.1 million for Ponto Falls Road upgrade
- ✓ \$26,700 for the Driver Reviver site at the Wellington Information Centre
- ✓ \$1.176 million for improvements at Wellington Caves
- ✓ \$1.2 million for security CCTV in Wellington and Calare communities
- ✓ \$650,000 for upgrades at Wellington Christian School
- ✓ \$200,000 for improvements at Kennard Park
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project Stage Two
- ✓ \$50,000 for Wellington Library's outdoor reading room
- ✓ Video link for Wellington Court House



ENERGYCO CAUGHT OUT IN ENVIRONMENTAL VANDALISM

The community is outraged that the NSW Government is bulldozing a centuries-old wildlife corridor near Gulgong, leaving dozens of baby native birds fighting for life.

Over the past month, as trees have been felled and woodchipped on both sides of Merotherie Road – more than 60 birds – parrots, birds of prey, kestrels – have been scooped up and handed to WIRES volunteers and local vets, all of whom are distraught.

EnergyCo is building transmission lines for the NSW Government's Central-West Orana Renewable Energy Zone.

I was at an event last Saturday in Mudgee where multiple community members approached me saying, "can you please look into this, we have to stop this destruction".

So, I wrote to the NSW Premier and requested he personally intervene and immediately direct EnergyCo to halt all further tree removal.

They have left a moonscape on Merotherie Road. It's total

destruction. It's scandalous.

EnergyCo say they've bought offsets somewhere else in NSW which makes it all right. But this doesn't pass the 'pub test' and it does nothing for the environment in our area.

EnergyCo probably thought it was out of sight, out of mind, being about 20 kilometres out of Gulgong. However, they didn't count on the fact that you've got some very passionate community members, including protectors of the environment who are outraged by this.

There is more tree felling and land clearing planned up in that area and the community is standing up and saying this has got to stop and EnergyCo must be held accountable.



APPLYING PRESSURE PAYS OFF FOR REGIONAL COMMUNITY HOUSING

Recently in Question Time I told the Minister for Housing that our regional community housing providers are being duded by the Housing Australia Future Fund.

Last week, Housing Plus CEO Justin Cantelo and I met the Federal Housing Minister, Clare O'Neill. In good news, the Minister promised that the next round of funding in the multi-billion-dollar fund would have a dedicated stream for regional communities.

While this is positive news we will continue the fight for our fair share for the Central West.



Andrew with Housing Plus CEO Justin Cantelo

MAJOR PARTIES FAIL TO BACK MY PRIME AGRICULTURAL LAND BILL

In Question Time last week I kept the pressure on the Minister for Agriculture, Julie Collins, and asked her if she would back my game-changing Bill to protect Australia's prime agricultural land. I asked the Minister:

"Our prime agricultural land is disappearing before our eyes, threatening Australia's food security. All over Australia we're seeing residential, industrial and renewable developments on our finest farming country. Our prime agricultural land needs to be preserved for agriculture. Will you support my Protecting Australia's Prime Agricultural Land Bill and will you come to the Calare electorate and meet with our local farmers?"

Disappointingly the Minister's response was a dud. I think

the answer shows why we have a problem here.

For generations the major parties have just been buck passing and playing the blame game and it goes across all levels of government. The Federal Government has the power to fix this. It needs to use that power.



HISTORIC BILL TO PROTECT PRIME AGRICULTURE HITS PARLIAMENT

Introduced the Protecting Australia's Prime Agricultural Land Bill 2025 in the House of Representatives last month.

It is the first Bill of its kind in Australia's history to preserve and protect our most productive farmland for its vital purpose of agricultural production.

The Bill requires that prime agricultural land must be used for agriculture.

It will make prime agricultural land 'off limits' to housing sprawl and industrial developments like renewable energy projects, which are jeopardising our food security, as well as our regional and national economies.

It's hard to believe that a country that relies so much on agriculture to sustain it, has never passed legislation to protect the land that is the source of such bounty.

Food and fibre production is vital for the ongoing success and prosperity of Australia, and its importance will only increase as our population continues to grow.

Australian farmers are the best in the world. The value of agricultural exports surged to \$77.2 billion, or 15.1 percent of Australia's total exported goods, in 2024- 2025.

It defies belief that we continue to build houses, parking lots and industrial developments on prime agricultural land. It's an epic fail.

Disappointingly, when the Bill was put to a vote, only one Liberal and one National Party member joined the crossbench to support it. Rest assured the Parliament has not heard the last of the Protecting Australia's Prime Agricultural Land Bill 2025.

There's too much at stake and this fight is only just beginning.

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Public Notice

Wellington Warriors FC
Annual General Meeting
Cow & Calf Meeting Room
15 December @ 5:30pm

Water Delivery

Domestic Water Deliveries
Servicing Wellington Region
Fiona: 0427 463 441 Ken: 0427 463 442

Church Services

Anglican Parish of Wellington
WELLINGTON – St John the Baptist Church
Sunday 9am
Sunday 5pm - The Gathering
MARANATHA
11am on 2nd & 4th Friday of month.

Wellington Baptist Church
77 Swift Street
9:30am Sunday mornings
6pm Evening Service

Wellington Uniting Church
Sunday at 9.30am

St Patrick's Catholic Parish
Saturday
6pm – Mass, St Patrick's Church, Wellington
8.30am - Stuart Town
Sunday
8am – Our Lady's Church, Yeoval first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
10am – Our Lady's Church, Yeoval second and fourth Sundays of the month
10am – St Patrick's Church, Wellington first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
8am – St Patrick's Church, Wellington second and fourth Sundays of the month
Weekday mass
Please check parish bulletin

In Christ Chapel
2pm Sunday

Riverside Church Inc.
170 Thornton Street
Sunday: 10.00am Service
Thursday: Bible Study for Men and Women 10.30 am

Everyone looks at the classifieds.

Promote your
Annual General Meetings, Social Club Events,

Birthday Parties

Homes and Flats to rent or wanted to rent

Lost and Found

Garage Sale

Memorium

Public Notice

Raffle prize winners

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The Wellington & District Leader now has a website and we invite you to join in. Open your search engine and type in Wellington District Leader or scan this QR code.



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Leader

Around the electorate with our State Member **Dugald Saunders**

Christmas card winner
A HUGE congratulations to Haniyya (Age 12 - Central West Leadership Academy) on her winning entry to my Christmas Card Competition for 2025!
Haniyya's Ultimate Christmas Feast will feature on the front of my Christmas card, which will be shared right across the Dubbo electorate.
Second and third place has been awarded to Addison (Age 11 - Mudgee Public School) and Skyli (Age 10 -St John's Primary School, Dubbo), respectively, and will also be featured on the card.
Thank you and well done to everyone who entered the competition this year; it's once again shown the breadth of talent, creativity and imagination we have right across our region.
I can't wait to share the works of these three budding artists as my Christmas card hits mailboxes over the coming weeks; some areas have already reported that they've received the card, so keep an eye out!

Diaries now available
The highly anticipated 2026 Legal Topics for Seniors Diary is now available from my office.
A strictly limited number of diaries are available; however, it will also be available from a variety of organisations, including Legal Aid NSW, local libraries and other community groups.
To secure your copy, visit my office at 1/18 Talbragar Street Dubbo, call 6882 3577 or email dubbo@parliament.nsw.gov.au ***
Connect IRL grants
Applications are now open to the Connect IRL Grants program.
Grants between \$10,000 to \$250,000 are available through this funding stream for eligible non-for-profits supporting young people through 'In Real Life' connections, including offline networking, mentoring, safe spaces, and prosocial activities.
For more, visit:

<https://www.nsw.gov.au/grants-and-funding/connect-irl-grants> ***
New dog rules
A NSW Government crackdown on unethical dog breeding practices has commenced.
From Monday 1 December, a Breeder Identification Number (BIN) is required for dog breeders and limits exist on the number of litters dogs can have.
There is a cap of 20 non-desexed female dogs over the age of six months to be kept on a premise, unless breeders have been granted an exemption, and one staff member is required at the breeding premise for every 20 dogs.
Female dogs will be limited to five litters in their lifetime or up to three by caesarean.
The changes come with new penalties, of a maximum \$110,000 penalty for an individual and \$550,000 for a corporation for exceeding the cap on female dog numbers with individuals also potentially facing gaol time.
Breeders can apply for a Breeder Identifi-

cation Number (BIN) online: www.petregistry.olg.nsw.gov.au/breeders ***
Still time to use Kid's Vouchers
There is still time for eligible families in the Dubbo electorate to use their Active and Creative Kids vouchers for 2025.
Families receiving Family Tax Benefit through Services Australia can apply for an Active and Creative Kids voucher for each eligible child.
These \$50 vouchers are available twice a year to help families with the cost of eligible active or creative activities with a registered provider.
Voucher 1 and voucher 2 for 2025 can be used together before 31 December 2025 for a combined value of \$100.
To apply for a voucher or find a registered provider, visit: <https://www.service.nsw.gov.au/active-and-creative-kids-voucher>
Until next time,
Dugald

New reforms give right to repair

THE STATE’S peak farm body has welcomed a Federal Government commitment to extend right to repair laws to agricultural machinery.

NSW Farmers’ President Xavier Martin said the reforms pledged by Federal Treasurer Jim Chalmers on Friday had followed years of advocacy by the Association.

“We’ve been calling for a legislated right to repair our farm machinery for a long time, and it’s brilliant to see our Federal Government has listened,” Mr Martin said.

“These reforms will slash the huge costs and wait times farmers are facing to get their machinery fixed – and that in turn will help them put food on tables and clothes on backs in a way that’s faster and more efficient than ever before.”

Warning on state’s hidden fire danger

FARMERS HAVE warned the state’s national parks have become ticking time bombs for bushfires this summer.

As authorities continued to confiscate large swathes of land to form national parks, NSW Farmers’ President Xavier Martin said vital resources to properly manage bushfire risks on public land had failed to follow.

“Farmers and communities have done a lot of work to prepare for this year’s fire season, but we’ve got a serious danger that’s out of our hands and out here on our doorstep,” Mr Martin said.

“This isn’t just a few fallen branches in these parks – we’re talking about huge tinderboxes of timber and vegetation that are just sitting here, simply waiting to explode.

“Fuel loads haven’t been managed at all well, and burnoffs aren’t happening when they should – so there’s real question marks about how safe we are living and working near these parks here in NSW.”

With the Productivity Commission estimating the reforms would boost agricultural productivity by \$97 million annually, Mr Martin said it was imperative the repairs market for farm machinery was opened as soon as possible.

“Farmers in countries like Canada have had this right for years – as has our automotive industry here in Australia – and it’s simply time we evened the score,” Mr Martin said.

“Enabling us to get our machines repaired by suitably qualified independent repairers will keep costs down and productivity up, so it’s really a no-brainer.

“If Jim Chalmers is serious about pushing up productivity, then pushing through this reform should be number one on his list for 2026.”

NSW Farmers’ Western Division chair Gerard Glover said the state government must step up and implement a serious regime to manage bushfire risks in national parks, with farmers in the west among those facing an uncertain summer ahead.

“Before they can even think about declaring another square inch of land as a mecca for pests, our governments have got to stop, think and invest real resources to reduce the bushfire risk in the national parks they’ve already got,” Mr Glover said.

“Some of these parks in the west of the state span hundreds of thousands of acres, and often there’s barely anyone monitoring them.

“Apparently it’s going to be another hot summer ahead, and as any Aussie can tell you, there is simply no room for complacency when it comes to bushfire season.

“If the average citizen had an opportunity to prevent a bad fire from becoming far worse, they’d take it. “The question is, would our governments do the same?”

tech

talk

with

Mathew Dickerson, Axxis Comworld

When Kerry Packer collapsed on a polo field in 1990, few could have predicted that his near-death experience would reshape emergency medicine in Australia.

What saved him that day wasn’t luck alone but technology that had quietly been evolving for decades.

The first portable defibrillator was invented in 1968 but by 1990, only some NSW Ambulances carried them.

Fortunately for Packer, his ambulance did.

A controlled electric shock restored the rhythm of his heart, bringing him back from the brink.

In typical Packer fashion, he phoned the Premier and offered to split the cost of fitting every NSW Ambulance with a portable defib.

He donated \$2.5 million, and soon the entire fleet was equipped with “Packer Wackers.”

Three decades later another high-profile cardiac arrest again underscored the value of defibrillators.

Greg Page - the Yellow Wiggle - collapsed

on stage during a bushfire relief concert.

But unlike in 1990, the lifesaving device wasn’t in the back of an ambulance; it was mounted on a nearby wall.

By then, automated external defibrillators (AEDs) had begun appearing in public locations.

Bystanders grabbed the AED, followed the spoken prompts, and delivered the shock that saved his life.

Greg went on to found Heart of the Nation, an organisation dedicated to placing more AEDs in communities.

Both stories highlight something important: the technology works, but only if it gets to the patient in time.

A defib stops the heart’s chaotic rhythm so it can restart normally - but the window to act is brutally short.

If an AED is used within the first minute, survival rates sit around 90 per cent.

Every minute that passes without a shock reduces those odds by about 10 per cent.

This puts enormous pressure on response times. Across Australia, the average

ambulance arrival for top-priority emergencies is around eight minutes in major cities.

That is a long wait for a heart that has stopped beating. Add heavy traffic, distance or high demand, and those minutes can stretch even further.

So, the question becomes: how do we get an AED to the patient faster?

One promising answer is by combining existing technologies. In parts of the United States, a pilot program is trialling autonomous drones to deliver AEDs directly to the scene of a cardiac arrest.

When a 911 call suggests someone’s heart has stopped, an ambulance is dispatched as usual - but so is a drone carrying an AED.

Immune to congestion, the drone takes a straight path to the address.

If it arrives before paramedics, it lowers the AED via a winch. The spoken prompts help a bystander through delivering the shock.

It’s a simple idea with enormous potential: shave even two or three minutes off the time to first shock and you can significantly

improve survival rates.

Crucially, the drones don’t replace paramedics. They complement them, plugging a gap in those critical early minutes before professional care arrives.

Drone-delivered AEDs could dramatically reduce the time it takes for lifesaving treatment to reach the patient.

It’s not hard to imagine this concept finding a home in Australia.

Our combination of sprawling suburbs, long distances and unpredictable traffic could make drone-assisted response more effective here than almost anywhere else.

One day, small drone stations might sit quietly above our neighbourhoods, ready to launch the moment someone dials triple zero.

From the first portable defib in 1968 to the “Packer Wackers” of the 1990s and the wall-mounted AEDs of today, each technological leap has saved more lives.

The next big leap may not be a new invention, but a smarter way of combining the ones we already have.

The power of community pays off with new passionate rural doctors

IT WAS an honour to address the first incredible cohort of rural doctors through the CSU School of Rural Medicine on Tuesday.

Here’s an excerpt from my speech.

“What a day it is for Charles Sturt University and country Australia!

The class of 2025 is making history today. It’s a day of joyous celebration for you, our newest doctors, and your families and your loved ones.

But it’s also a day of joy and triumph for the country communities who fought so hard for this day to come.

This medical school was built on the fundamental tenet of equality. The simple notion that country people deserve the same access to medical care as those in the cities.

You, the class of 2025, to us represent the promise and future of country Australia.

So there’s no pressure!

Many of you will have overcome many obstacles along your road to becoming doctors.

Many sacrifices will have been made by you and your families, and your loved ones. And the road to the establishment of this medical school was also a long and winding one.

And just as your graduation is testament to the power of your dreams, the very existence of this medical school is testament to the power of dreams and the power of community.

Being a pioneer isn’t always easy. There may be times in your professional lives when you come home from a hard or bad day at work, when nothing seems to have gone right. You might ask yourself, “what am I doing here?”

Everyone in every occupation has those days – believe it or not, sometimes we even have it in politics as well.

When it happens to you, just remember that our communities will still be with you, will be cheering for you and will be willing you to carry on and succeed – all of you. Not every graduate has such overwhelming community support, but you all do.

Before I was in politics, I was a solicitor and then a barrister. And with the passing of time and the benefit of perspective, one of the things I learnt is that often the most rewarding work is work you carry out for little or no financial reward. So, when the day comes that your phone



The

Gee

Report

Andrew Gee

Federal Member for Calare



rings, or there’s a knock at your door, and it’s a colleague or a family member, or most likely a person or even a group of people that you’ve never met. And they say they need your help and that they have no one else to turn to. Answer the call. No matter how busy, or inconvenient it may be, answer the call.

For me personally, this represents one of the proudest days I’ve had in my time in politics. And as I look around this room, I see many people who are just as proud.

I would particularly like to acknowledge former Vice Chancellor Andy Vann, who is here today, and lived the fight for this medical school every day for many years. Thank you, Andy.

And you the class of 2025 are the trail blazing first wave of doctors to graduate from CSU.

But the truth is, in the midst of a worsening rural doctor shortage crisis, we desperately need more of you.

Here at CSU, Commonwealth-funded places have been capped at 37 for five years.

And while we’ve recently been granted a further 10 places, which is a good start, rest assured the fight for more CSU doctors to join you will not cease.

On behalf of our communities, we give you our warmest and heartfelt congratulations.

You are making history today. Good luck. Best wishes. Now go and show ‘em what a CSU doctor can do!

tech

talk

with

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TV

6.00 Morning Programs. **10.30** The Piano UK. **11.15** Tech Smart Agriculture. **11.30** Crime Night! **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** Silent Witness. **2.00** Death In Paradise. **3.00** QI. **3.30** Forever Summer With Nigella. **3.55** Grand Designs New Zealand. **4.40** Long Lost Family. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** Grand Designs Australia. **9.00** Long Lost Family. **9.45** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **10.35** ABC Late News. **10.50** The Business. **11.10** The Art Of. **11.40** Late Programs.

two **6.00** Morning Programs. **1.00** Escape To The Country. **2.00** South Aussie With Cosi. **2.30** Our Town. **3.00** The Zoo. **3.30** Harry's Practice. **4.00** RSPCA Animal Rescue. **4.30** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.30** Escape To The Country. **6.30** Bargain Hunt. **7.30** Father Brown. **8.30** The Inspector Lynley Mysteries. **11.40** Late Programs.

Entertains **6.00** Morning Programs. **2.05** ER. **2.50** Heartbreak High. **3.35** A Bite To Eat. **4.05** QI. **4.40** MythBusters. **5.30** Remarkable Renovations. **6.15** Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. **7.05** Claire Hooper's House Of Games. **7.35** QI. **8.05** Would I Lie To You? **8.35** Hard Quiz. **9.05** Gruen. **9.45** Late Programs.

7

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** The Ashes: Pre-Game Show. **3.00** Cricket. The Ashes. Second Test. Aust v England. Afternoon. **5.00** The Ashes: Tea Break. **5.40** Cricket. The Ashes. Second Test. Aust v England. Evening session. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6:30. **7.00** Cricket. The Ashes. Second Test. Australia v England. Day 1. Evening session. **7.40** The Ashes: Dinner Break. **8.00** Cricket. The Ashes. Second Test. Australia v England. Day 1. Late evening session. **10.30** Seven's Cricket: The Spin. Return. **11.15** Late Programs.

mate **6.00** Morning Programs. **2.30** The Force: BTL. **3.30** Swamp People: Serpent Invasion. **4.30** American Resto. **5.00** American Pickers. **6.00** Cricket. The Ashes. Second Test. Aust v England. Evening session. **7.00** Pawn Stars. **7.30** American Pickers. **8.30** **MOVIE**: S.W.A.T. (2003) **11.00** Late Programs.

Family **6.00** Kids' Programs. **2.45** To Be Advised. **3.00** Kids' Programs. **6.45** Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. **7.05** Batwheels. **7.35** Ninjago: Dragons Rising. **8.00** Operation Ouch! **8.35** Secrets Of The Zoo. **9.20** Secret Life Of The Kangaroo. **10.05** The Mysterious Benedict Society. Final. **10.35** Late Programs.

9

6.00 Today. **9.00** Today Extra Summer. **11.30** 9News Morning. **12.00** Golf. PGA Tour of Australasia. Australian Open. First round. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** Holidays In The Sun. New. **8.30** Topknotz: Wild On Water. **9.30** Limitless With Chris Hemsworth. **10.30** Chicago Med. **11.20** Next Stop. **11.50** Tipping Point. **12.40** Pointless. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **2.00** Late Programs.

flixx **6.00** It's Academic. **7.30** Get Clever. **8.30** News Of The Wild. **9.00** Home Shopping. **10.00** The Food Dude. **10.30** My Kitchen Rules. **12.00** S.W.A.T. **3.00** House Of Wellness. **4.00** The Goldbergs. **4.30** Bondi Vet. **6.30** Judge Judy. **7.30** Ramsay's Kitchen Nightmares. **10.30** Ramsay's 24 Hours To Hell And Back. **11.30** Late Programs.

NEWS **6.00** Morning Programs. **3.00** ABC News Afternoons. **4.00** Afternoon Briefing. **5.00** ABC News With Joe O'Brien. **6.00** ABC News Hour. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** ABC News Tonight. **8.45** The Business. **9.00** The World. **10.00** ABC Nightly News. **10.25** Boyer Lecture Series. Final. **11.00** Late Programs.

10

6.00 Morning Programs. **8.30** Deal Or No Deal. **9.00** Lingo. **10.00** Ent. Tonight. **10.20** Jamie Oliver: Cooking For Less. **11.30** My Market Kitchen. **12.00** Farm To Fork. **12.30** Family Feud. **1.00** News. **2.00** Deal Or No Deal. **2.30** Lingo. **3.30** 10 News: Afternoon. **4.00** Neighbours. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.00** 10 News+. **7.00** Deal Or No Deal. **7.30** Big Brother Australia. **8.30** The Graham Norton Show. **9.40** Law & Order: SVU. **10.40** 10's Late News. **11.05** 10 News+. **12.00** Late Programs.

drama **6.00** Home Shopping. **8.00** Escape Fishing With ET. **9.00** The Living Room. **10.00** JAG. **12.00** Days Of Our Lives. **12.45** The Young And The Restless. **1.30** Ambulance UK. **2.40** JAG. **4.30** The Living Room. **5.30** JAG. **7.30** NCIS. **10.20** Ambulance UK. **11.30** Blue Bloods. **12.25** 48 Hours. **2.25** Home Shopping.

Gem **6.00** Morning Programs. **2.00** Find My Country House NZ. **2.30** GolfBarons. **3.00** Golf. PGA Tour of Australasia. Aust Open. **5.00** Antiques Roadshow. **5.30** Yorkshire Auction House. **6.30** Antiques Roadshow. **7.30** Clarkson's Farm. **8.30** **MOVIE**: Love Of An Icon: The Legend Of Crocodile Dundee. (2025) **10.20** Late Programs.

SBS

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** WorldWatch. **2.00** Chef Antonio's Recipes For Revolution. **3.45** The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. **4.15** Everywhere. **5.05** Jeopardy! **5.30** Letters And Numbers. **6.00** Mastermind Australia. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.35** Eva Longoria: Searching For Spain. **8.25** Britain's Railway Empire In Colour. **9.20** Vigil. **10.25** SBS World News Late. **10.55** Vienna Blood. **12.50** House Of Promises. **3.30** Home Of The Year: Scotland. **4.35** Bamay. **5.00** Late Programs.

comedy **6.00** Morning Programs. **1.00** Ridiculousness. **2.30** Poppa's House. **3.00** Becker. **3.30** Frasier. **4.00** Farm To Fork. **4.30** Frasier. **5.00** Becker. **5.30** Frasier. **6.30** Neighbours. **7.00** Friends. **8.00** The Big Bang Theory. **9.30** Becker. **10.00** Frasier. **11.00** Ridiculousness. **11.30** Late Programs.

VICELAND **6.00** Morning Programs. **2.10** Bamay. **2.40** Insight. **3.45** WorldWatch. **5.45** Mysteries From Above. **6.40** Jeopardy! **7.35** 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. **8.30** History's Greatest Mysteries. **10.10** The UnXplained With William Shatner. Return. **11.00** Homicide: Life On The Street. **11.50** Late Programs.

TV

6.00 News Breakfast. **9.00** ABC News Mornings. **10.00** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **11.05** The Forsytes. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** The Newsreader. **2.00** Grand Designs Australia. **3.00** QI. **3.30** Forever Summer With Nigella. **3.55** Grand Designs New Zealand. **4.45** Long Lost Family. **5.25** Antiques Roadshow. **6.25** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** Gardening Australia. Final. **8.30** Maigret. **9.25** Hard Quiz. **9.55** Crime Night! **10.25** Spicks And Specks. **10.55** ABC Late News. **11.10** Silent Witness. **12.15** Late Programs.

two **6.00** Morning Programs. **1.00** DVine Living. **1.30** Escape To The Country. **2.30** The Zoo. **3.00** The Great Australian Doorstep. **3.30** Harry's Practice. **4.00** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.00** Escape To The Country. **6.00** Bargain Hunt. **7.00** Better Homes And Gardens Summer. **8.30** Escape To The Country. **11.30** Late Programs.

Entertains **6.00** Morning Programs. **2.50** Heartbreak High. **3.35** A Bite To Eat. **4.05** Would I Lie To You? **4.40** MythBusters. **5.30** Remarkable Renovations. **6.15** Phil Spencer: Secret Agent Specials. **7.05** House Of Games. **7.35** QI. **8.05** Would I Lie To You? **8.35** **MOVIE**: Geostorm. (2017) **10.30** Late Programs.

7

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** The Ashes: Pre-Game Show. **3.00** Cricket. The Ashes. Second Test. Aust v England. Afternoon. **5.00** The Ashes: Tea Break. **5.40** Cricket. The Ashes. Second Test. Aust v England. Evening session. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6:30. **7.00** Cricket. The Ashes. Second Test. Australia v England. Day 2. Evening session. **7.40** The Ashes: Dinner Break. **8.00** Cricket. The Ashes. Second Test. Australia v England. Day 2. Late evening session. **10.30** Unfiltered: Cricket. **11.00** Late Programs.

mate **6.00** Morning Programs. **3.30** Swamp People: Serpent Invasion. **4.30** American Restoration. **5.00** American Pickers. **6.00** Cricket. The Ashes. Second Test. Australia v England. Day 2. Evening session. **7.00** Pawn Stars. **7.30** Road Wars. New. **8.30** **MOVIE**: Blade Runner 2049. (2017) Ryan Gosling. Harrison Ford. **11.45** Late Programs.

Family **6.00** Kids' Programs. **2.45** To Be Advised. **3.00** Kids' Programs. **6.25** The Adventures Of Paddington. **6.45** Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. **7.05** Gardening Australia Junior. **7.35** Star Wars: Young Jedi Adventures. **8.00** Scooby-Doo And Guess Who? **8.30** Hard Quiz Kids. **9.00** Robot Wars. **10.00** Merlin. **10.40** Late Programs.

9

6.00 Today. **9.00** Today Extra Summer. **11.30** 9News Morning. **12.00** Golf. PGA Tour of Australasia. Australian Open. Second round. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** Find My Beach House Australia. **8.30** **MOVIE**: Aquaman And The Lost Kingdom. (2023) Jason Momoa, Patrick Wilson, Yahya Abdul-Mateen II. **11.00** Law & Order: Organized Crime. **11.50** **MOVIE**: Sons Of Summer. (2023) **1.30** Late Programs.

flixx **6.00** Morning Programs. **10.30** My Kitchen Rules. **12.00** S.W.A.T. **2.50** Emergency Call. **3.20** The Goldbergs. **4.15** First Dates UK. **5.15** Bondi Vet. **6.10** **MOVIE**: Lyle, Lyle Crocodile. (2022) **8.30** **MOVIE**: Maid In Manhattan. (2002) Jennifer Lopez, Ralph Fiennes, Natasha Richardson. **10.45** **MOVIE**: Click. (2006) **1.00** Late Programs.

NEWS **6.00** Morning Programs. **3.00** ABC News Afternoons. **4.00** Afternoon Briefing. **5.00** ABC News With Joe O'Brien. **6.00** ABC News Hour. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** ABC Evening News. **8.05** Your Say: Digital Dilemma. **9.00** The World. **9.30** Close Of Business. **10.00** ABC Nightly News. **10.30** Asia News Week. **11.00** Late Programs.

10

6.00 Morning Programs. **9.00** Lingo. **10.00** Ent. Tonight. **10.20** Jamie Oliver: Cooking For Less. **11.30** My Market Kitchen. **12.00** Farm To Fork. **12.30** Family Feud. **1.00** News. **2.00** Deal Or No Deal. **2.30** Lingo. **3.30** 10 News: Afternoon. **4.00** House Hunters Australia. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.00** 10 News+. **7.00** Deal Or No Deal. **7.30** Big Brother Australia. **8.30** Sam Pang Tonight. **9.30** The Graham Norton Show. **10.40** 10's Late News. **11.05** 10 News+. **12.00** Late Programs.

drama **6.00** Home Shopping. **8.00** Escape Fishing With ET. **9.00** The Living Room. **10.00** JAG. **12.00** Days Of Our Lives. **12.45** The Young And The Restless. **1.30** Ambulance UK. **2.40** JAG. **4.30** All 4 Adventure. **5.30** JAG. **7.30** NCIS. **10.20** Ambulance UK. **11.30** Blue Bloods. **12.25** 48 Hours. **2.25** Home Shopping.

Gem **6.00** Morning Programs. **2.00** Find My Country House NZ. **2.30** GolfBarons. **3.00** Golf. PGA Tour of Australasia. Aust Open. **5.00** Antiques Roadshow. **5.30** Yorkshire Auction House. **6.30** Antiques Roadshow. **7.30** Antiques Downunder. **8.30** **MOVIE**: U.S. Marshals. (1998) Tommy Lee Jones. **11.10** The Equalizer. **12.10** Late Programs.

SBS

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** WorldWatch. **2.00** **MOVIE**: Rewards For The Tribe. (2023) **3.35** The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. **4.05** Unwheel Adventures. **5.05** Jeopardy! **5.30** Letters And Numbers. **6.00** Mastermind Australia. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.30** **MOVIE**: Strange Journey: Story Of Rocky Horror. (2025) **9.05** Discovering Film: Diane Keaton. **10.00** Rock Legends. **10.30** SBS World News Late. **11.00** Sisi. **12.00** Tokyo Vice. **2.15** Soldiers. **3.00** Going Places With Ernie Dingo. **4.00** Late Programs.

comedy **6.00** Morning Programs. **12.00** Ridiculousness. **2.00** The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. **3.00** Becker. **3.30** Frasier. **4.00** Farm To Fork. **4.30** Frasier. **5.00** Becker. **5.30** Frasier. **6.30** Friends. **7.30** **MOVIE**: Meet The Parents. (2000) Robert De Niro. **9.50** Becker. **10.15** Frasier. **11.05** Ridiculousness. **11.30** Late Programs.

VICELAND **6.00** Morning Programs. **2.10** The Bee Whisperer. **3.00** Bamay. **3.35** WorldWatch. **5.35** If You Are The One. **6.35** Jeopardy! **7.30** 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. **8.30** Virgin Island. **10.20** Adam Hills: The Last Leg. **11.15** What It Feels Like For A Girl. **1.15** Letterkenny. **2.30** NHK World English News. **5.00** Al Jazeera NewsHour.

TV

6.00 Rage Charts. **7.00** Weekend Breakfast. **9.00** Rage. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **12.30** Return To Paradise. **1.25** Maigret. **2.40** Melbourne Symphony Orchestra. **4.50** Spicks And Specks. **5.20** Landline. Final. **5.50** Australian Story. **6.30** When The War Is Over. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** Return To Paradise. **8.30** Vera. **10.00** The Forsytes. **10.55** Bergerac. **11.40** Rage.

two **6.00** Home Shopping. **8.30** Travel Oz. **9.30** Better Homes And Gardens. **12.00** Horse Racing. Country Classic Day and Ballarat Cup. **6.00** Dog Patrol. **6.30** The Yorkshire Vet. **8.30** Escape To The Country. **11.30** The Yorkshire Vet. **1.30** The Great Australian Doorstep. **2.00** RSPCA Animal Rescue. **2.30** Creek To Coast. **3.00** Late Programs.

Entertains **6.00** Morning Programs. **2.15** ER. **3.00** Heartbreak High. **3.45** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **4.40** MythBusters. **5.30** Remarkable Renovations. **6.15** Phil Spencer: Secret Agent Specials. **7.05** Spicks And Specks. **7.35** QI. **8.05** Live At The Apollo. **9.35** Absolutely Fabulous New York Special. **10.30** Late Programs.

7

6.00 Morning Programs. **1.00** Motorbike Cops. **1.30** Border Security: Int. **2.00** The Ashes: Pre-Game Show. **3.00** Cricket. The Ashes. Second Test. Aust v England. Afternoon. **5.00** The Ashes: Tea Break. **5.40** Cricket. The Ashes. Second Test. Aust v England. Evening session. **6.00** Seven News. **7.00** Cricket. The Ashes. Second Test. Aust v England. Evening session. **7.40** The Ashes: Dinner Break. **8.00** Cricket. The Ashes. Second Test. Australia v England. Day 3. Late evening session. **10.30** Late Programs.

mate **6.00** Morning Programs. **2.00** Rides Down Under: Workshop Wars. **3.00** Motor Racing. NDRK Nitro Funny Cars. Riverbend Nationals. **4.00** Desert Collectors. **5.00** Counting Cars. **6.00** Cricket. The Ashes. Second Test. Aust v England. Evening session. **7.00** Storage Wars. **7.30** **MOVIE**: The 6th Day. (2000) **10.00** Late Programs.

Family **6.00** Kids' Programs. **6.05** PJ Masks. **6.25** The Adventures Of Paddington. **6.50** Andy And The Band. **7.05** Piripenguins. **7.30** Hard Quiz Kids. Final. **8.00** Harry Potter: Hogwarts Tournament Of Houses. Final. **8.40** Chopped Junior. **9.25** Fresh Off The Boat. **10.05** Abbott Elementary. **10.30** Speechless. **10.50** Late Programs.

9

6.00 Getaway. **6.30** A Current Affair. **7.00** Weekend Today. **10.00** Today Extra Summer. **12.00** Golf. PGA Tour of Australasia. Australian Open. Third round. **5.00** 9News First At Five. **5.30** Find My Country House Australia. **6.00** 9News Saturday. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** **MOVIE**: Mrs Doubtfire. (1993) Robin Williams, Sally Field. **10.00** **MOVIE**: Bad Moms. (2016) Mila Kunis, Kathryn Hahn. **11.55** **MOVIE**: The Founder. (2016) **2.00** The Incredible Journey Presents. **2.30** Late Programs.

flixx **6.00** Morning Programs. **1.00** Starstruck. **2.30** Extended Family. **3.00** Dancing With The Stars: All Stars. **4.30** Toddlers Make You Laugh Out Loud. **5.45** **MOVIE**: Open Season. (2006) **7.30** **MOVIE**: The Invention Of Lying. (2009) **9.35** **MOVIE**: Redeeming Love. (2022) Abigail Cowen. **12.20** Late Programs.

NEWS **6.00** Morning Programs. **3.00** News. **3.30** If You're Listening. **3.50** News. **4.05** Your Say: Digital Dilemma. **5.00** News. **5.30** Asia News Week. **6.00** Evening News. **6.30** Culture By Design. **7.00** National News. **7.30** Compass. **8.00** News Tonight. **8.30** TBA. **9.00** Nightly News. **9.30** The Pacific. **10.00** Late Programs.

10

6.00 Morning Programs. **8.00** I Fish. **8.30** On The Fly. **9.00** 4x4 Adventures. **10.00** My Market Kitchen. **10.30** GCBC. **11.00** Airport 24/7. **12.00** Everyday Gourmet. **12.30** Farm To Fork. **1.00** Silvia's Italian Masterclass. **1.30** The Yes Experiment. **2.00** 4x4 Adventures. **3.00** Planet Shapers. **3.30** Well Traveller. Final. **4.00** All 4 Adventure. **5.00** 10 News. **6.30** The Dog House Australia. **7.30** Selling Houses Australia. **8.30** Location, Location, Location Australia. **9.45** FBI: Most Wanted. **11.40** Late Programs.

drama **6.00** Morning Programs. **2.30** Camper Deals. **3.00** Tough Tested. **4.00** Reel Action. **4.30** Soccer. A-League Men. Round 7. Newcastle Jets v Melbourne City. **7.00** Football Tonight. **7.35** Soccer. A-League Men. Round 7. Central Coast Mariners v Sydney FC. **10.00** NCIS. **11.50** Late Programs.

Gem **6.00** Morning Programs. **11.00** The Baron. **12.10** **MOVIE**: The Courtneys Of Curzon Street. (1947) **2.30** **MOVIE**: Birdman Of Alcatraz. (1962) **5.30** **MOVIE**: Crossplot. (1969) **7.30** Death In Paradise. **8.30** **MOVIE**: Dr No. (1962) Sean Connery, Ursula Andress, Joseph Wiseman. **10.45** **MOVIE**: Death Wish V. (1994) **12.45** Late Programs.

SBS

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** BBC News At Ten. **12.30** FIFA World Cup 2026 Final Draw. **2.30** Soccer. Australian Championship. Final. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.30** Alpine Train At Christmas. **8.25** Christmas At Graceland. **9.15** Rock Legends. **9.45** Living Black. **10.15** Reckless. Final. **11.20** Homicide: Life On The Street. **2.40** Being Beethoven. **3.45** Home Of The Year: Scotland. **5.00** NHK World English News Morning. **5.15** France 24 Feature. **5.30** ANC Philippines The World Tonight.

comedy **6.00** The Bold And The Beautiful. **8.30** The Living Room. **10.00** Ridiculousness. **11.00** Farm To Fork. **11.30** Deal Or No Deal. **12.00** The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. **2.00** Ridiculousness. **3.00** Frasier. **4.00** Friends. **6.30** The Big Bang Theory. **10.00** Frasier. **11.00** Ridiculousness. **12.00** South Park. **1.00** Home Shopping. **1.30** Late Programs.

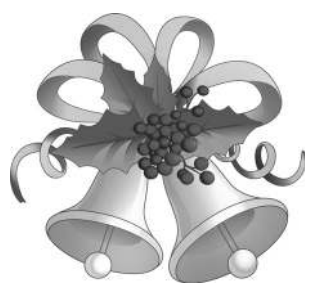
VICELAND **6.00** Morning Programs. **3.40** WorldWatch. **5.40** Mastermind Australia. **6.40** Inside Legoland: A World Of Wonder. New. **7.35** Impossible Engineering. **8.30** Cult Massacre: One Day In Jonestown. **9.25** Shenzhong Tunnel Bridge. **10.25** Snowpiercer. **12.20** Letterkenny. **2.05** NHK World English News. **5.00** Late Programs.

5x5

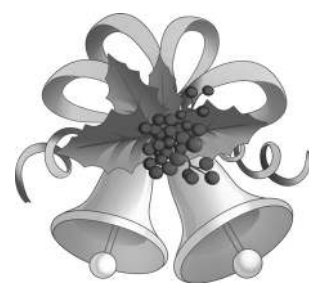
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Insert the missing letters to make 10 words – five reading across the grid and five reading down.

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Co-op going from strength to strength

IN THE two years Wellington Craft Cooperative has been located in the former Nitty Knotty Nook building at 146 Percy Street, the group has attracted some 100-plus members from throughout the Wellington region.

From profit in the past 12 months the Co-op has donated upwards of \$4000 to local schools and children's charities. (See story on Page 3).

And there are funds left over to give the building's facade a brand new facelift.

Co-op spokesperson Penny Cook said the Nitty Knotty Nook original sign writing would be revived as well as including the years from when Ron and Judy Cosier were running the craft business in the shop.

"We want to do this as a tribute to

Judy and Ron Cosier whose family has been so generous and supportive to us," Penny said.

After Ron's death the family donated to the Co-op most of Judy's craft within the shop prior to its close.

"Most of us got into craft while Ron and Judy had the shop and so we all had relationships with both of them, and that's why the shop front facade uplift is a lovely tribute to them as they were the foundation to a lot of us crafters in the area," Penny said.

Talking for the many visitors the Co-op attracts, Penny said they have some wonderful visitors who become customers.

"They come from surrounding villages and towns and the Central West, who have discovered us and just keep coming back," she said.

"As well, there are passers-through, and many say their friends had been here and suggested they call in and have a browse.

"These sorts of stories are awesome, people just keep visiting from all parts of the state, and it's every day.

"Basically, everything on the shelves are all hand crafted, but as well there are some bric-a-brac vintage antique items that have been given to us which we also sell."

The Co-op also sells items for crafting use like yarn, fabric, paints, needlecraft and cross-stitching items.

Penny said the Co-op won the best shop window display at this year's Wellington Show and their sourdough bread lady won the champion bread of show award.

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Christmas and New Year vehicle preparation a must - see T & N Auto



AT T & N Auto & Ag, our goal is to make sure your vehicle is completely ready for the upcoming Christmas and New Year holidays.

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Our services cover important tasks like changing oil and filters, checking brakes and tires, testing batteries, and verifying fluid levels and check suspension - all designed to keep your journey safe and

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Your safety and comfort on the road are always T & N's top priorities.

They don't just look after cars - T & N Auto & Ag also specialise in maintaining agricultural equipment including tractors and headers.

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Repair services include both new and older vehicle servicing, air conditioning, wheel alignment, vehicle diagnostics, brake and transmission repairs, clutch work, roadwor-

thy inspections, suspension, and many other automotive needs.

We sincerely thank our community for your ongoing support.

Your trust and loyalty mean a great deal to us and have been key to our continued success.

Please note: T & N Auto & Ag will be closed from 24th December 2025, reopening on 5th January 2026. We wish everyone a happy, safe, and joyful Christmas and New Year.

For enquiries, call 026845 1112 or visit us at 92 Lee Street, Wellington (between Domino's Pizza and the old NRMA building).

Four Cats for coffee, eats and a whole range of treats

IF ANY business in Wellington could be called the community 'hub', then Four Cats Coffee would be the place.

Inside or outside under the shady trees and foliage, Four Cats offers the space for a catch-up, or a circle of friends to meet up.

And while daytime hours from as early as 7.30am offer quick coffee pick-up or a relaxed sit-down cuppa with or without a snack or meal, the friendly staff enhance the quiet and friendly feeling one gains when visiting.

Much of this serenity stems from the fact that the building is the former Sisters of Mercy Spanish styled Infant School in Warne Street where classrooms now offer relaxation during a sip or bite to eat.

Mine host, Kylie Barton and her team offer a range of exciting delights on the menu and specials board from Four Cats specialty steak sandwich to toasties or sweet pastries supplied by Racine.

Popular toastie is the avocado breakkie, then there is the bacon and egg roll, quiche and salad or pie and salad. Salads change with the season, while over-the-counter sales of Althea by Zin Mudgee sour dough bread are offered fresh with two deliveries each week.

And the coffee is the 7Miles roasted by Bill's Beans of Orange.

The homemade cakes and slices complement the coffee.

Kylie is keen to sell and promote local produce from the re-

gion and some very recent additions include The Flour Millers Wife classic nostalgic childhood biscuits like Honey Jumbles, Gingerbread and Sprinkle Yo-Yos from Manildra.

There's also Tracey own's Dripstone Apiary honey and Burton's Lane tomato Kussaubdi from Millthorpe, Curry Paste or Brinjal Pickles.

From Bourke, there's Di Ridge's Poppy Seed |Salad Dressing and Olive d'or produced by the Wilson Family of Narromine.

Plus unique homewares, vintage goods and plants display of Alicemary Designs.

Friday and Saturday evenings come alive with Black Cat Cocktails served by Tom and Jess from early evening to late.



Caves wood gallery is worth the short drive out of town



LOOKING FOR a unique Christmas gift, then a drive out to the Caves Wood Gallery and Gifts will delight.

Located on the left just before the Wellington Caves carpark, this all-Australian handmade gift shop will surprise you with many beautiful items.

Owners Chris Hardy and Ken Vodden may be more recognizable through their untiring work with Wellington Lions, however, their other life has been running the gallery for the past 10 years and more.

Not only do they have a great selection of giftware, they also have a range of Christmas themed items to browse through.

Ken has hand-crafted timber Christmas trees, small or big to choose from, and they can fold so

they are recyclable and re-useable. The smaller ones have decorations already on them.

There is a wonderful array of Christmas ornaments like hand-made balls, angels, Christmas stockings and Christmas cards.

The eye will be taken by the huge range of handmade jewellery, timber ornaments, vases, plates, wood turning items, chopping and pizza boards, pizza knives, Australian timber pens, and even something as unique as a fish skin pen, there's so much to choose from when searching for that perfect gift, any of which would help to fill a Christmas stocking for that special person.

There is a new range of vintage artwork, and preloved 1960's China and glassware.

In fact, Chris Hardy is offering a 10 per cent discount on these

preloved 1960s China and glassware, so get in quick

. "We have gifts for babies, clothes, cross-stitched hand towels, crafty things for ladies that like crocheting, knitting, crochet boxes, timber jewellery, and I make necklaces, earrings, bracelets with semi-precious gems."

Not only can you browse through the shop, there's some interesting items outside to look at as well.

"We encourage locals to come out and have a look at the beautiful land here, we have the original caves bird aviary as well as the stone echidna, and a giant chess set."

"We hope everyone has a happy and healthy Christmas and a happy new year, Australia is still the lucky country."

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The past week saw only showers for most of the district with harvesters losing little time.

Mice about
A warning from Animal Control Technologies we will see rising mice numbers in 2026.
MLA reports large lamb markets, the highest since June 2025. Some 3,668,000 across the state with the prices holding firm.
WOOL. AWI reports a very strong market mid November showing the EMI up 33.7%. Cotton continued its downward trend down to \$570.9/bale.
OILSEEDS. Canola \$806/t, up .8%. **PULSES.** Chickpeas \$527/t, up 3.9%.
GRAIN. Marketing blogs sell smart: why watching market trends can help you act before prices drop. For cereal and oilseed growers, timing a sale can be as important as yield. When market trends suggest prices may be heading down, waiting too long can mean missing out on a profitable price. You need to closely monitor market trends. In the volatile world of grain markets having a clear and proactive marketing strategy is essential. One powerful tool growers can use is setting a target price - a predetermined price at which they're willing to sell part or all of their grain. View market trends over one week or by one, three, or six months until your offer price is made on the basis of 42% oil and 0% admix price adjustments made per industry standards (AOF) consider when setting your offer price.
If you have completed an ISCC declaration on the national grower register for your canola, you can let all buyers know when you create your offer.

Markets at a glance
WOOL.. EMI closed at 1504c/kg clean, down 10c.
39,161 bales offered, up 7365 bales (lower number next sale). Sydney.. Merino fleece designated superfine sale produced 100 to 200 cent gains among (<17 micron) lots. Strength and CVH were rewarded. Superfine and broken fleece lines with low (<5%) VM sold at a premium both days. Crossbred 26-micron MPG rose 6% on day 1, the 28-micron MPGs lifted 10c on day2. Oddments and cardings unchanged. NMI closed at 1541c/kg clean, down 16 cents. Sydney Pass-in 8.5%, 187 bales withdrawn.
CATTLE:-25th CTLX CARCOAR Numbers lifted 524 for 3692 head. Young cattle to trade firm to dearer, yearling steers 420c to 486c, heifers 385c to 372c/kg. Feeder steers back 10c, 440c to 545c, heifers down 15c, 390c to 472c/kg. Grown cattle firm to cheaper, heavy steers 410c to 480c, heifers 340c to 460c/kg. Cows firm ,2&3 scores 340c to 402c, heavy cows 395c to 432c/kg. Bulls sold to 400c/kg.
SHEEP:—CTLX CARCOAR 26th 4761 sheep (+454) 7290 lambs (-3105). Mostly light new season lambs and good runs of trade and heavy lambs. Not all regular buyers operating, market Cheaper. Light new season lambs to processors dropped \$20, \$120 to \$222. Trade new season lambs 20kg to 24kg eased \$8, \$240 to \$287, ave 1170c/kg cwt. Over 24kg \$294 to \$306. Light store lambs \$20 cheaper, \$90 to \$268. Trade old lambs \$180 to \$250, heavy \$240to \$336. Best hoggets reached \$260.
There were 4761 mutton, prices \$15 cheaper. Merino ewes \$100 to \$285. XB ewes \$105 to \$260. Merino wethers \$105 to \$225, xb wethers, \$176 to \$260. Most sheep 200 to 250c/kg cwt.

STOCK CLEARANCE
Dips Fly prevention, ag chem, fungicides, fencing, electric and conventional, poly pipe, fertilizer and seeds small packs and cabinets all must go.



Dubbo (02) 6885 0549



Wellington 0427 919 062

WEEKLY MARKET REPORT

Week ending November 28, 2025

AWEX Northern Micron Indices Comparison

AWEX INDEX	This Week \$22/25	This Week M22/25	Last Sale \$21/25	Sydney Change	Last Year Sydney	Sydney Yearly Change
17	2118	2059	2143	-25	1698	+420
18	2000	1980	2028	-28	1538	+462
19	1869	1864	1885	-16	1411	+458
20	1812n	1815	-	-	1348n	+464
21	-	1806	-	-	-	-
26	-	760	749n	-	571n	-
28	660n	665	675n	-15	395n	+265
MC	805n	745n	805n	n/c	706n	+99

Larger offering softens market

MARKET SIGNALS given to growers over the past three weeks led to a larger offering of more than 39,000 bales last week. The 100-cent or more rises in most of the Merino indicators from the close of the last sales was unable to be held, but unlike the same scenario a couple of months ago, the market reaction was more of a drift rather than a panicked correction. The quantity of Merino fleece was similar in number between the micron groups, with the designated superfine sale having a good offering of those types. The mid to broader Merino fleece held up a little better than the finer end, with the staple Chinese 19.5 and 21 micron having the best support. Merino skirtings went against the trend, lifting 40 cents, with buyers struggling to find enough to fill orders. Such is the demand for the knitwear product that they are processed into. Crossbreds came off between 7 to 18 cents, whilst cardings had a positive result, lifting up to 12 cents. Exporters have expressed some frustration that the offering size can have large fluctuations from week to week, and the sentiment change from processors, particularly the small to medium sized Chinese mills. This has long been debated within the industry about how we can structure a system that allows for a more orderly flow of quantity, but for now, there isn't and doesn't look like a method that will bring it into play. Growers offer for various reasons, mainly because they need the cashflow, but some are able to hold off after shearing and wait until the market is at a level they are more comfortable with. Chinese processors particularly are struggling to absorb the reduced production figures and test data from AWTA and accuse buyers of exaggerating the truth on supply when larger quantities come onto the market. Market signals have the largest effect in quantities offered currently, which doesn't look like changing heading forward, giving processors and buyers a challenging environment to be trading in. This week Macwool and Carmichael wool had one of their smallest combined offerings, with only 310 bales catalogued for sale on Tuesday.

YOUR WOOL IN SAFE HANDS



Plasto & Company

Livestock and Property Pty Limited

Stock report by Ross Plasto

DUBBO CATTLE yarded 10,150, another near-record yarding, just 30 head less than last week. Good numbers of prime cattle in all sections and plenty to suit feeders and back-grounders. Less feeders and back-grounders operating though most processor buyers were active. Young trade cattle 12c cheaper, vealers and yearlings 380c to 500c/kg.
Feeder steers 12c cheaper, heifers up to 23c/kg cheaper. Feeder steers 448c to 518c, heifers 365c to 489c/kg. Young restocker steers 15c cheaper, heifers firm. Young steers to 568c, heifers to 500c/kg. Grown steers and heifers 15c cheaper, steers 438c to 489c, heifers 405c to 470c/kg. Cows 4c to 9c dearer, 3-scores to processors 350c to 402c/kg. Heavy cows 380c to 431c, ave 407c/kg. Cows to restockers 272c to 398c/kg.
Bulls dearer to 424c/kg.
Dubbo Prime Lambs sale 18,600. Mostly plain yarding, odd pens of well finished trade and heavy lambs mixed throughout. Large numbers of secondary exotic lambs showing effects of dry, hoggets once again well supplied. Light processor lambs \$10 cheaper, 12kg to 18kg 2-scores \$105 to \$185. Trade lambs up to \$30 cheaper, 20kg to 24kg old lambs \$210 to \$294, ave 980c to 1070c/kg cwt. Heavy lambs also up to \$30 cheaper, over 24kg \$252 to \$360. Merino lambs \$10 cheaper, trade weights \$153 to \$246. Restocker and feeder lambs firm, restockers paid \$46 to \$199, feeders paid to \$182. Hoggets to \$328.
Mutton. 12,725 mixed mutton

Around the tracks with Col Hodges

Racing at Bong Bong

NARROMINE-BASED Ricky Blewitt travelled to the Southern Highlands and rode the opening winner at the recent Bong Bong picnic races.
Riding for Cessnock trainer Jeremy Sylvester, Blewitt led for home on Clan D'Oro (\$2.50 favourite) which staved off a strong challenge to win the 1000 metres Asbourne Maiden Plate in a close finish from Eternity Star (Sebastian Galea, \$2.70) and Bella Madonna (Leandro Ribeiro, \$5).
Although he missed a place on outsider Tycoon Charger in the feature race this year, Ricky Blewitt has won the Bong Bong Picnic Cup three times, on the Steve Turner trained Shaggy Miss, the James Cummings trained Colour Of Money and on Frenzied for the Gai Waterhouse and Adrian Bott trainer partnership.
The 2025 KJ Scaffolding Bong Bong Picnic Cup (1560m) was won by the Anthony Warren, Canberra trained Valentine John ridden by Sebastian Galea formerly from Dubbo and now a trackwork rider for prominent trainer Phillip Stokes in Victoria.
Close to the leader at the top of the straight, Valentine John (\$11) won the Cup by a long-neck from San Marco (Leandro Ribeiro, \$3.60 fav) and Zartamay (Bessie Dimery, \$7).
Making a comeback, Ramon Perez (47) at his first race ride in over 25 years, won the 1000m Gubbins Pulbrook Mitre 10 Class 2 Handicap at Bong Bong on Aegipan.
Clinging to a slender lead in the straight, the Patrick Murphy, Goulburn trained Aegipan (\$4), responding to strong riding from Perez, held on to beat Picksix (Leandro Ribeiro, \$7) and Sontag (Sebastian Galea, \$2.50 fav).
Before coming to Australia in 2010, Ramon Perez was the leading apprentice jockey in North America and rode 390 winners including two winners at Group 1 level
Apprenticed to Hall Of Fame inducted trainer William Mott in America, Ramon Perez became too heavy for race riding and although he had left school at a young age studied for years and became a qualified veterinary surgeon which is his occupation in Australia.

Picnic racing is now in recess until next year and resumes at Bedgerabong on Saturday, February 14 followed by Condobolin Saturday, February 21 and Yass on Saturday, February 28.
Meanwhile, racing on Friday (Mudgee Cup) and Dubbo (Monday) followed by Warren on Friday, December 12, Coonamble Saturday, December 13 and Orange Monday, December 15.

Home for Christmas?

Then bring the family for a
relaxing day at
**BOXING DAY
RACES**
Friday, 26 December

We now have a digital edition.

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email: sharon@wdleader.news



Wellington Public School

Intensive Swimming



20 THURSDAY, DECEMBER 4, 2025, WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER

Golfing News Summer golfing challenge hits-off

SUMMER CHALLENGE competition kicked off last Saturday with 14 teams contesting, plus there was an Individual Stableford.

Winner of the day's golf was Marie Cornish who had a sensational front-9, an OK back-9, her final score was 39pts on a countback.

Runner-up and welcome back, Norm Royal who hasn't forgotten what is needed on a golf course, his final score 39pts.

Prize winners were Liam Conn 38pts; Reid Armstrong, Jeremy Barton, David East 37pts; Patrick Slack-Smith, Jono Smith, Rod McMahon, John Gersbach 36pts; James Fleming, Nate Conn, Bryan Kiss, Noel Stanford, Jordan Disney, Jono Smith 36pts; Ron Cowan, Tim Parker, Cody Conn, Robert Payne 35pts, Doug Ney, David Wilson, Gary McCarroll, Drew Stone 34pts; Cathy Loo-Shui, Joe Ryan 33pts on a countback.

Nearest the Pin on 3rd Kurt Cusack, 8th Brad Hyland, 14th Tim Parker, 16th Kurt Cusack. Club sponsored NTP in two-shots on the 12th went to Kurt Cusack and 9th John Donnelly.

Jespresso Cafe longest drives went to Kurt Cusack in A grade and Drew Stone in B grade. Brent Eather Encouragement award

was taken out by Sam Lemon who had a shocker of a day, his final score 21pts.

Wednesday's ladies day was a Ransom event, but the weather played havoc with only six holes played, the event was sponsored by Kim Gersbach.

Winners were Marie Cornish and Cathy Loo-Shui with 21pts, also ask Cathy about her DANCE on the 1st hole on Saturday.

Runners-up were Wendy Slack-Smith and Carmel Cohen finishing with 18pts. Ladies also had their presentation day and Christmas celebrations.

Winner of Thursday's Individual Stableford was Nathan Stewart who put together a score of 39pts and was heard to say gee its peaceful without the Captain here.

Runner-up went to Brock Naden who also had a good day finishing with 38pts.

Prize winners were Joe Ryan, Rod McMahon, Peter Holden 37pts; Ashley Bullock 36pts on countback.

Iberdrola, Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club 9-hole Round 8 winner was Neale McCabe with a great score of 32nett. Runner-up was Joe Ryan with 33nett. Wayne Lang won the raffle.

Front nine holes to be played this week.

Results of the Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws Summer Competition Round 1 were not forwarded.

Draw for Round 2 Bell River Bandits take on Dirt Diggers, Railway Boys v Lion of Waterloo, Kevaliers v The Dirty Birds, Snipers v Pheonix, WMC v The Masters, Soldiers Club v Maulers, Used Groceries v Power Rangers.

This Saturday's events are the December Monthly Medal kindly sponsored by Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club plus the Medals of Medals, Round 2 of the Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws Summer Competition, and Round 1 of the Naveau Earthmoving Trophy as well, a busy Saturday coming up.

A grade Qualifiers for the Medal of Medals are Matt Redfern, David Naveau, Sam McManus, Nathan Stewart, Jordan Stanley, Stephen Whiteman, Tim Parker, John Gersbach, John Donnelly, Jeremy Barton, Matt Ringland.

B grade Qualifiers are Steve Kiss, Brad Conn, Peter Holden, Liam Conn, Jono Smith, Matt Conn, Garry McNaughton, Paul Hannelly, Ben Kiss, Rod Pedron. 19th Hole



Marie Cornish is showing some sensational style lately. She won last Saturday's Individual Stableford with 39points.

Get involved in the big Summer read



Macquarie Regional Library's Suzie Samson with Mayor Josh Black.

TO HELP maintain literacy levels over the summer school holiday period, Macquarie Regional Library through the Wellington Library is introducing the Big Summer Read.

This reading incentive program is for ages 5 to 16 years and started this Monday through to Saturday, January 31 next year.

The Wellington Library has a great range of books for children and young people as well as access to a large range of e-books and audio-books via apps such as Libby, Borrow Box, IndyReads and U Library.

Library manager Kathryn McAlister said the branches have a great variety of books that can be borrowed free of charge with a library card.

"Our team members are always on hand to help with reading suggestions and to help encourage children to explore the wonderful world of books," Ms McAlister said.

If your child is five and under, the library has an Early Literacy Bingo competition.

Simply collect a bingo sheet any-time in December and January then complete the card and hand in to the

library to receive a small prize and entry into the major prize draw.

Mayor Josh Black said the summer school holidays were a great opportunity to continue to develop and grow a child's literacy skills as well as their love for reading.

"We want to encourage kids to pick up a book as reading is a great form of entertainment and relaxation with the benefit of supporting your child's reading skills ready for when they return to school next year," Clr Black said.

To join Big Summer Read, visit Wellington Library and pick up a log to track your reading.

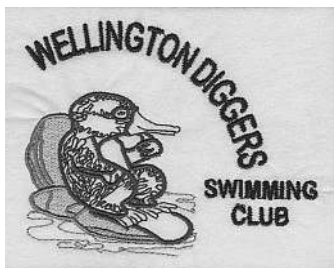
Children mark off each day they read a book, magazine, graphic novel or listen to an audiobook.

At the end of the program, children return their completed log to the library to receive a prize and an entry into the major prize draw.

Not a member of the Macquarie Regional Library? You can join for free.

For more information about the Big Summer Read visit www.mrl.nsw.gov.au or visit Wellington Library.

Wellington Diggers Swimming Club News



THIRTEEN MEMBERS participated in our weekly swim on Tuesday, November 25.

Di Donnelly and Janelle Frappell shared the spoils in the 30-metre event being 0.50 outside their time.

Wayne Rich won the 50-metre event being 0.31 outside his time.

Once again Rhylee Hill won the junior events while Nick Knowles and Albert Rich won the Brace Relay being 4.78 outside their time.

Swimming commences at 6pm each Tuesday at the Aquatic Leisure Centre.

To compete in our weekly swim adults must be members of the Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club and for juniors to compete a family member



Diggers Swimming Club is open to all, families included, but you need to be a member of the Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club.



Early morning training is keeping Wayne Rich ahead of the pack. He won the 50m swim on Tuesday.

must compete on the night.

Membership is \$2 for adults, swim cost is \$5 per person plus pool entry. After swim BBQ is included.

The Western District Championships will be held in Cobar on Sunday, February 8, 2026. Cost will be advised.

New members are always welcome and for more information contact Terry Dray – 0408 294 526. Results for Tuesday – 25 November 2025

Juniors

25 Metre: 1 Rhylee Hill 0.25; 2 Albert Rich 0.54; 3 Darcy Lousick 2.09.

50 Metre: 1 Rhylee Hill 1.28; 2 Albert Rich 3.69; 3 Darcy Lousick 7.59.

Seniors

25 Metre: 1 Di Donnelly & Janelle Frappell 0.50; 2 Nick Knowles & Lizzi George 0.69; 3 Terry Dray 1.08.

50 Metre: 1 Wayne Rich 0.31; 2 Di Donnelly 0.72; 3 Nick Knowles 1.00.

Brace Relay: 1 Nick Knowles & Albert Rich 4.78; 2 Darcy Lousick & Henry Willcockson 7.75

The Platypus

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Warren Carnival & Friday Pointscore

Carmen Gain photos

Wellington swimmers shine at Pointscores and Warren Carnival

WELLINGTON SWIMMERS delivered an impressive performance across the weekend, with a strong turnout and exceptional results recorded at both the Friday night Pointscores and Sunday's Warren qualifying carnival.

A total of 72 swimmers attended Pointscores on Friday evening, where many achieved personal best times in freestyle and backstroke events.

On Sunday, seven Wellington swimmers travelled to Warren and produced outstanding performances.

The highlight came from Elsie Gain, who broke a long-standing Wellington Club Record in the 8 years 100m backstroke, clocking an impressive 2:04.93 minutes.

This surpassed Felicity Williams' 1988 record of 2:06.13.

Dash for Cash winners in their respective age groups were Elsie Gain, Roman Dowton and Lakyn Dowton.

Several swimmers enjoyed notable success across multiple events.

Roman Dowton claimed first place in all of his events and finished third in the 50m backstroke

Brodle Frogley recorded personal bests in the 50m butterfly, breaststroke and backstroke.

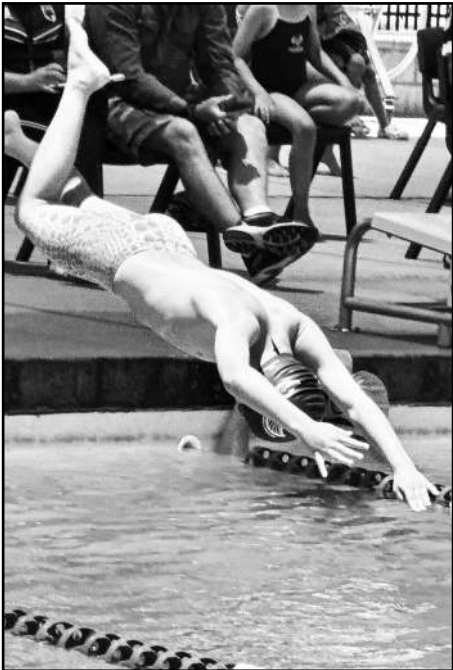
Elsie Gain went on to secure first place in four events and second in the 50m backstroke.

Imogen Jones achieved top-two finishes in all of her events, while Macy Jones dominated the pool, winning the 100m freestyle and 50m backstroke, placing second in the 50m freestyle and third in the 200m freestyle.

Lakyn Dowton finished in the top two in all of his events, and Ronnie Tandy-Bell won all of his Multi-Class events.

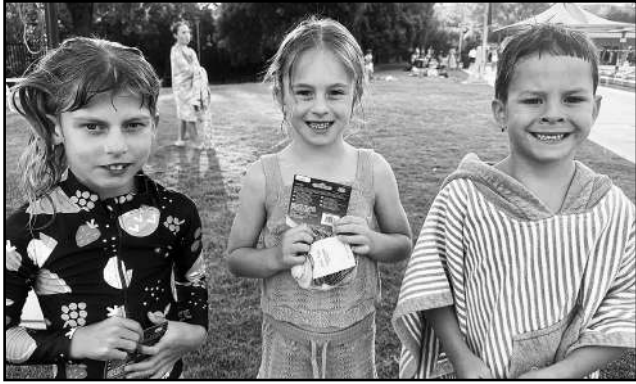
These outstanding results reflect the dedication, determination and talent of Wellington's young swimmers, along with the support of their families, coaches and club volunteers.

Carmen Gain



Warren Carnival & Friday Pointscore

Carmen Gain photos



Wellington regains Western Cricket girls championship

Wellington High School Girls Cricket Team – Marie Cornish Knockout

IT'S BEEN a few years, but they are back on top!

WHS Girls Cricket Team is officially Western Champions after a brilliant week of cricket and a well-deserved win in the Marie Cornish Knockout Final.

After defeating Bathurst High last week in the semi-final, the girls put on another outstanding performance to overcome Mudjee High in the Final at Pioneer Park.

The next challenge awaits: the State Top Eight Playoff, to be played early next year in an exciting new two-day T20 format.

The High School offered a huge congratulations to all the girls, and a special shout-out to those who don't normally play but stepped up to support their mates. True WHS spirit!

Match Highlights

Semi-Final vs Bathurst High

WHS won the toss and sent Bathurst in to bat and who took full advantage of the fast outfield and small boundaries, posting a strong total of 1/135

from their 20 overs.

Our best bowlers were: • Addy – 0/25 off 4; • Olivia – 0/18 off 4; • Acadia – 1/16 off 4.

A shaky start to our chase saw Talia dismissed in the first over, but an unbeaten 138-run partnership carried us to victory with three overs to spare:

Top scorers: Addy – *79 and Olivia – *29.

A special mention to Bathurst batters Romy (*80) and Milla (*30) on their impressive efforts.

Final vs Mudjee High

With home-ground advantage, Mudjee won the toss and elected to bowl.

Our openers settled in before building momentum and both carried their bats through the innings: • Olivia – *77; • Talia – *66. A total of 0/182 after 20 overs.

Our bowlers worked cohesively, supported by some spectacular boundary saves from Alia and Nikiyah, keeping Mudjee to 85 after their 20 overs.

A special mention to Grace from Mudjee who scored a solid 30.



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Soldiers Memorial & Golf Club

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